



MAHARATHY SAITHY

DISMANTLING LICENCE RAJ

The New Industrial Policy of July 1991 was released, freeing most sectors of the economy of licencing obstacles. Sectors like aviation were opened to private players for the first time.

DEATHLY DESTRUCTION

On October 20, a low-intensity earthquake hit the Garwhal hills. Measuring 6.6 on the Richter scale, it lasted less than a minute. But when the earth stopped quaking, most of Uttarkashi, Tehri and Chamoli were devastated, with at least 1,000 dead in Uttarkashi alone, and over 42,000 destroyed.

ELSEWHERE...

- The Persian Gulf War (below) began as the US led a 30-nation coalition to liberate Kuwait from Iraq.
- Germany formally regained complete independence after the four post-World War II occupying powers—France, the United Kingdom, the United States and the Soviet Union—relinquished all remaining rights.
- Mikhail Gorbachev,

AP PHOTO



leader of the Soviet Union for almost seven years and executive president for nearly two, stepped down from office as the Soviet Union broke up into Russia and the CIS.

\$975 million

was India's foreign exchange reserve at the peak of the July forex crisis. At the time, India had to swap 20 tonne of its gold in the Swiss market. Later, it also shipped an additional 46 tonne of gold to London as collateral.



PORTRAIT OF A MARRIAGE

Bollywood moved into the bedroom and dispensed with blushing rosebuds and twittering birds as Govind Nihalani made a bold attempt at exploring infidelity with *Drishti*. Dimple Kapadia and Shekhar Kapur played a couple exploring extra-marital affairs that lead to a breakdown of their marriage.



PRASHANT KANUNJIA

ATAL BIHARI VAJPAYEE BJP LEADER

"The present Muslim generation is not to be punished for what their forefathers did."